

# Primary Source Annotation 4: Wartime Letter

Due: Friday, October 23 at 11:59 PM

Value: 30 points

Format: 600-word primary-source annotation

## Purpose

Read a personal wartime letter as a shaped communication rather than an unfiltered record of experience.

## Your task

- Choose one World War I letter from an Indian soldier, West African carrier, British nurse, Ottoman civilian, or Australian infantryman in the course sourcebook.
- Identify writer, recipient, route of transmission, censorship environment, and likely purpose.
- Analyze two details of language, omission, reassurance, rumor, or sensory experience.
- Explain how distance between front and home shaped the letter and what corroborating source would help test your interpretation.

## Submit

- 600-word annotation PDF with one short quotation and Chicago citation.

## Grading criteria

| Criterion           | Pts | Full-credit evidence                                                 |
|---------------------|-----|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Context             | 7   | Accurately situates creator, audience, place, and historical moment. |
| Close reading       | 9   | Analyzes two specific features of the source with careful evidence.  |
| Interpretation      | 8   | Makes a defensible claim and distinguishes inference from fact.      |
| Limits and citation | 6   | Names silences or limits and supplies a complete Chicago citation.   |

## Submission standards

Upload a readable PDF unless the handout specifies another format. Include your name, course code, and assignment title. Cite borrowed ideas and retain the editable source file. The learning portal timestamp is the official submission time.